

Kimia Nadjahi

knadjahi@mit.edu | https://kimiandj.github.io/

Research Experience

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (Cambridge, USA) Dec. 2022 –
Postdoctoral Fellowship Program for Engineering Excellence

Distinguished postdoctoral fellow in the Geometric Data Processing group, Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence Laboratory (CSAIL), MIT Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science. Supervised by Justin Solomon

Sorbonne University (Paris, France) Dec. 2021 – Dec. 2022
Postdoctoral Fellowship

Postdoctoral fellow within the *Laboratoire de Probabilités, Statistique et Modélisation* (LPSM). Supervised by Julie Josse and Claire Boyer

Microsoft Research Lab (Montréal, Canada) April 2018 – Aug. 2018
Internship

Research intern within the Reinforcement Learning team. Supervised by Romain Laroche and Rémi Tachet des Combes

RIKEN Center for Advanced Intelligence Project (Tokyo, Japan) April 2017 – Sept. 2017
Internship

Research intern within the Approximate Bayesian Inference team. Supervised by Emtiyaz Khan

Education

Télécom Paris (Institut Polytechnique de Paris, France) Oct. 2018 – Nov. 2021
PhD degree

- Supervised by Roland Badeau, Alain Durmus and Umut Şimşekli
- Title: "Sliced-Wasserstein distance for large-scale machine learning: theory, methodology and extensions"
- Keywords: computational optimal transport, approximate inference, deep generative modeling, large/high-dimensional data

ENS Cachan (Cachan, France) Sept. 2016 – Sept. 2017
MSc in Machine Learning and Computer Vision (MVA)

Master's thesis: "Generalized matrix factorization using conjugate-computation variational inference"

Ensimag (Institut Polytechnique de Grenoble, France) Sept. 2013 – Aug. 2016
Engineer's degree in Computer Science and Applied Mathematics

Lycée Saint-Louis (Paris, France) Sept. 2011 – Aug. 2013
CPGE MPSI-MP

Publications

Preprints

[1] R. Ohana*, **K. Nadjahi***, A. Rakotomamonjy, L. Ralaivola. *Shedding a PAC-Bayesian Light on Adaptive Sliced-Wasserstein Distances.* arXiv, 2022.

Proceedings of International Conferences

[2] S. Kolouri, **K. Nadjahi**, S. Shahrampour, U. Şimşekli. *Generalized Sliced Probability Metrics.* IEEE ICASSP 2022.

[3] **K. Nadjahi**, A. Durmus, P. E. Jacob, R. Badeau, U. Şimşekli. *Fast Approximation of the Sliced-Wasserstein Distance Using Concentration of Random Projections.* NeurIPS 2021.

[4] **K. Nadjahi**, A. Durmus, L. Chizat, S. Kolouri, S. Shahrampour, U. Şimşekli. *Statistical and Topological Properties of Sliced Probability Divergences.* NeurIPS 2020. **Accepted as a spotlight presentation** (≈ **3% of all submissions**: 280 spotlights out of 9454 submissions)

[5] **K. Nadjahi**, V. De Bortoli, A. Durmus, R. Badeau, U. Şimşekli. *Approximate Bayesian Computation with the Sliced-Wasserstein Distance.* IEEE ICASSP 2020.

[6] **K. Nadjahi**, A. Durmus, U. Şimşekli, R. Badeau. *Asymptotic Guarantees for Learning Generative Models with the Sliced-Wasserstein Distance.* NeurIPS 2019. **Accepted as a spotlight presentation** (≈ **2.5% of all submissions**: 164 spotlights out of 6743 submissions)

[7] S. Kolouri*, **K. Nadjahi***, U. Şimşekli, R. Badeau, G. K. Rohde. *Generalized Sliced Wasserstein Distances.* NeurIPS 2019.

[8] **K. Nadjahi***, R. Laroche*, R. Tachet des Combes. *Safe Policy Improvement with Soft Baseline Bootstrapping.* ECML-PKDD 2019.

Workshops

[9] WiML Workshop 2019 (Vancouver, Canada). **Contributed talk** (8 contributed talks selected among ≈ 600 submissions), *"Asymptotic Guarantees for Learning Generative Models with the Sliced-Wasserstein Distance"*

[10] European Workshop on Reinforcement Learning 2018 (Lille, France). *"Soft Safe Policy Improvement with Baseline Bootstrapping"*

[11] UAI 2018, "Safety, Risk and Uncertainty in RL" workshop (Monterey, USA). *"Soft Safe Policy Improvement with Baseline Bootstrapping"*

Awards and Grants

MIT School of Engineering Postdoctoral Fellowship for Engineering Excellence (Annual stipend of $75 000 and additional funds of $10 000 for conference travel and research expenses)

IP Paris Best Thesis Award 2022, First Prize (€3000 prize)

Best Paper Award at IEEE ICASSP 2022 for publication [2] ($1500 prize)

Best Reviewer (Top 10%) for ICML 2021, awarded free registration to the conference

Best Student Paper Award at IEEE ICASSP 2020 for publication [5] (€1000 prize)

Top 10% of high-scoring reviewers for NeurIPS 2020, awarded free registration to the conference

Travel grant ($1120) by Women in Machine Learning to present publication [6] at WiML Workshop 2019 (Vancouver, Canada)

Travel grant ($1400) by NeurIPS to present publication [6] at NeurIPS 2019 (Vancouver, Canada)

Third-place winner of *DataPower* hackathon by Engie (2016), out of 20 teams (€2000 prize)

Teaching Experience

Télécom Paris Oct. 2018 – Oct. 2021

Teaching assistant

- Basic Algebra, Basic Analysis, Analysis and Probability (MDI111–114, Bachelor): 12h
- Factorization-Based Data Analysis (DK917, Master): 9h
- Introduction to Graphical Models (DATA905, Master): 7h
- Optimization for Machine Learning (SD-TSIA211, Master): 18h
- Statistics: Linear models (SD-TSIA204, Master): 9h
- Statistics, Machine Learning and Linear Models (MDI720, Executive Master): 12h
- Time series, part 2 (TSIA202b, Master): 15h

OpenClassrooms Jan. 2018 – March 2018

Freelance editor

- Created the MOOC "How to process and classify image data" from scratch, in collaboration with Prof. Pascal Monasse (Imagine, ENPC)
- The online course is part of the "Data Scientist path" offered by OpenClassrooms in partnership with Centrale Supélec. It lasts 15h and features 3 chapters, 2 quizzes and 1 tutorial

Services

Student Program and Funding Chair of WiML Workshop at NeurIPS 2022

Reviewer for AISTATS (2020, 2021), NeurIPS (2020 – 2022), JMLR, WiML Workshop 2019

Expert reviewer for ICML 2021

Selected Invited Talks

Health data and model-driven Knowledge Acquisition (HeKA) team seminar, Inria Paris, Nov. 2022

Mokaplan team seminar, Inria Paris, Nov. 2022

Models and Inference for Neuroimaging Data (MIND) team seminar, Inria Saclay, July 2022

Statistical and Geometric Divergences for Machine Learning Research School, Mathematical Center Henri Lebesgue (Rennes, France), June 2022

Journées de Statistique de la SFdS, annual conference organized by the French Statistical Society (Lyon, France), June 2022

Optimal Transport and Statistical Learning workshop by GDR ISIS-MIA, Institut Henri Pointcaré (Paris, France), Nov. 2021

Causal Inference and Missing Data Group team seminar, Inria, June 2021

SIERRA team seminar, ENS/Inria Paris, March 2021

Paris Machine Learning Meetup, Dec. 2020

OxCSML team seminar, University of Oxford, May 2020

Data Science & AI for Digitalized Industry & Services Chair seminar, Télécom Paris, Sept. 2019

Skills

Programming

- Python (advanced use), C/C++, Java, Matlab, R.
- Open-source code available at https://github.com/kimiandj

Languages

French (native), English (fluent, TOEIC 955/990), Spanish (conversant), Persian (reading, conversant)